

Watcher v2 — Build Roadmap

From a message filer to a receptionist. Every item scored for urgency and ease. • 3 August 2026

The whole gap in one line: the pipeline can listen and file, but it cannot reply. Three outcomes exist and all three mean “put this somewhere”. Adding a fourth — **answer the customer** — is the project.

Where we stand today

Built and tested	Missing
86 passing tests, no DB or network needed 66 Python files, 10 modules 11 DB tables + migration Every external system behind a swappable seam Eval runner + job queue (unmerged branch)	A reply path — it cannot talk back Memory across turns — each message judged alone Knowledge — zero tables, zero rows A channel-neutral core — it still speaks WhatsApp Live availability — no read path to any PMS

How to read the scores

NOW	Today or tomorrow. Something is actively bleeding, or it blocks other work.
HIGH	This sprint. The demo does not exist without it.
MED	Needed before a real client, not before a demo.
LOW	Do it when convenient. Nothing waits on it.
Trivial	Minutes. A setting, a click, a delete.
Easy	Understood problem, no design decisions left open.
Moderate	Real work, but the pattern already exists in the repo to copy.
Hard	Genuinely new. Nothing in the repo to copy from.

Totals: ~14.5 engineering days. At six days a week that is a demo in about two weeks and a real client's guests on it in about three. Meta verification no longer sets the date — they allow starting unverified — so **engineering is the critical path**.

Track 0 — Today. Hours, not days.

Nothing here takes a full day, and three of the five unblock everything downstream. If only one thing happens today, make it 0.3.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
0.1	Set default branch to main	NOW	Trivial	1 min	Anyone cloning today lands on a feature branch. Harmless now, confusing the moment branches drift.
0.2	Remove the client name from the golden set and fixtures	NOW	Easy	0.25	A real client and address sit in a public repo, breaking your own anonymisation rule. Decide separately whether to rewrite history.
0.3	Decide the receptionist intent vocabulary	NOW	Easy	1 hr	A founder call, not code. Blocks four items (1.2, 2.4, 2.5, and the golden set). Cheapest and most blocking thing on this page.
0.4	Merge the eval branch	NOW	Trivial	0.25	Verified conflict-free and green: +15 tests, 86 to 101, all passing. Runner, five measures, reports, recorded fixtures, plus the job queue. A merge commit, not a fast-forward — main has moved since.
0.5	Delete the stale nifty-johnson branch	LOW	Trivial	1 min	Housekeeping your own roadmap already flags.

Track 1 — Foundations. Week 1.

Do 1.1 before anything else is built. Every week it waits adds more call sites to change.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
1.1	Stop the core speaking WhatsApp	NOW	Moderate	1.5	wa_message_id to external_id, wa_chat_id to thread_id, add a channel field. A phone call has no chat id. Strict typing plus 86 tests point at every site, so this is a rename, not a rewrite.
1.2	Port the four kept scaffold files	HIGH	Moderate	1.0	Not a copy-paste. They import the wrong package root, and the boundary test bans the word “whatsapp” while the actual leak is the wa_ prefix — so the test meant to prevent this bug would not catch it. Needs 0.3 first.
1.3	Python 3.12 to 3.13	LOW	Easy	0.5	Baseline corrected: the repo is on 3.12, not 3.10. Upgrade surface checked and clean — no removed stdlib, no deprecated datetime calls. Do it after 1.1 so a breakage has one suspect, not two.

Track 2 — Make it a receptionist. Week 2.

This is the product. 2.1 is the only item with nothing in the repo to copy from.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
2.1	Conversations, tasks and slot filling	HIGH	Hard	2.0	Hold a goal across several messages instead of judging each alone. New tables, new migration, wired into the orchestrator. The one genuinely new piece of domain work.
2.2	The reply path	HIGH	Moderate	1.5	A fourth outcome, a composer, and sending back out through the connector. Retries and dead-lettering already exist for CRM writes — this adds the direction, not the machinery.
2.3	Autonomy gate, and raise the acting floor	HIGH	Easy	1.0	Small code, important thinking. High acts, medium acts and tells someone, low fetches a human. Half-confident is fine for filing, not for holding a booking. Money and owner matters always reach a person, checked <i>before</i> confidence.
2.4	Knowledge base	HIGH	Moderate	2.0	Facts table with sensitivity flags, prose in pgvector, and a real “I don’t know” that fetches a human. Door codes are not ordinary facts. For the demo, one property’s facts fit in the prompt — no retrieval needed.
2.5	Prompt v2 and rewrite the golden set	MED	Moderate	1.0	Receptionist vocabulary, 8 cases rewritten and ~50 added. The runner from 0.4 already exists to score them. Needs 0.3.

Track 3 — Integration and launch. Week 3.

Base360.ai is ruled out as a partner: their product is substantially ours and their client base is closed to us. Hostaway, Guesty and Cloudbeds all publish APIs, so the capability is available without the strategic cost.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
3.1	PropertySystemPort plus the first adapter	MED	Moderate	2.5	Build the port, not a Hostaway integration. Verified: crm_cache already has external_record_id and last_synced_at, but delivery exposes only post() — write-only, so this needs a new read port. Cache facts; never cache availability.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
3.2	End to end on a real number, then measure	HIGH	Moderate	1.0	The point at which the eval number becomes real rather than recorded.

Runs in parallel — start on day one

None of these are engineering. All of them can quietly become the reason a date slips.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
P1	Pick the first client	NOW	Easy	—	Decides which PMS adapter gets built first. Without it, 3.1 is a guess.
P2	Read the Hostaway / Guesty / Cloudbeds API docs, get sandbox keys	HIGH	Easy	0.5	Public docs, usually self-service sandboxes. Shape the port from what two or three of them offer <i>in common</i> .
P3	File Meta business verification	MED	Easy	1 hr	No longer blocking — unverified start is allowed, and a receptionist mostly replies inside the 24-hour window. File it anyway before volume makes it bind.
P4	Graphify as a build aid (optional)	LOW	Easy	0.5	Maps the repo for the coding agents during the 1.1 rename. Local parsing, no vector store, nothing leaves the machine. Install from the GitHub repo — several lookalike domains exist.

The dates

Milestone	When
Eval merged, name leak fixed, vocabulary decided	End of day 1
Core stops speaking WhatsApp; scaffold files ported	End of week 1
Holds a conversation and replies — rough demo	Middle of week 2
Knowledge and safety rules in — demo-ready	End of week 2
Live availability, measured, on a real number — pilot-ready	Middle of week 3
Phone answering	Week 4

Phone lands in week 4 rather than later because the speech-to-text seam already exists in `media/pipeline.py`. It was built for voice notes and turns out to be most of what a phone connector needs.

What would actually move these dates

The vocabulary decision drifting. One hour of founder time that blocks four items. If it slips a week, everything slips a week. This is the single highest-leverage hour on the whole plan.

Knowledge base scope creep. The 2.0 days assumes a structured intake form plus PMS sync. “Can it read our PDF handbook?” is a different and much larger project. Say no for now.

Quality, not features. Getting to *working* is two weeks. Getting to *trustworthy* — where it never invents a check-in time — is measured by the eval runner, and that number is not fully under your control. Budget a tuning tail.

PMS API access. Docs are public, but sandbox approval and rate limits are theirs to grant. Start P2 on day one; it is the new version of the Meta-verification lesson.

If you do only one thing today: decide the intent vocabulary (0.3) and merge the eval branch (0.4). One is an hour of thinking, the other is a code review. Together they unblock roughly half of everything below them.